Table 12.4: Normal flora of human gastrointestinal tract

At human birth	Stomach and intestine are sterile
Breast fed babies	*Lactobacillus bifidus*
Bottled milk fed babies	Enteric bacteria, *Lactobacillus* bifidus, *Enterococci, Clostridium* sp
Small intestine	*Lactobacilli, Enterococcus faecalis, Escherichia coli*
Large intestine	Anaerobic bacteria, *Streptococci*, *Bacteroides, Bifidobacteriumbifidum*

Dysentery: Inflammatory disorder of the GIT associated with pus and blood in feces.

Gastritis: Inflammation of the stomach lining that results in swelling.

Enteritis: Inflammation of the intestinal mucosa

Colitis: Inflammation of the colon

Hepatitis: Inflammation of the liver

Enterocolitis: Inflamation involving the mucosa of both large and small intestine.

Peritonitis: Inflammation of peritoneum (it is the serous membrane that forms the lining of the abdominal cavity). Infections of digestive system are listed in Table 12.5.

Table 12.5: Diseases of the digestive system

Infection	Pathogen	Symptoms
Bacterial Diseases		
Staphylococcal food poisoning	*Staphylococcus aureus*	Nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea
Shigellosis (bacillary dysentery)	*Shigella sp-*	Tissue damage and dysentery
Salmonellosis	*salmonella enterica*	Nausea and diarrhea
Typhoid fever	*Salmonella typhi*	High fever, significant mortality
Cholera	*Vibrio Cholerae*	Diarrhea with large water loss
Yersinia gastroenteritis	*Yersinia enterocolitica*	Abdominal pain and diarrhea, usually mild; may be confused with appendicitis
Viral Diseases		
Mumps	*Mumps virus Paramyxoviridae*	Painful swelling of parotid glands
Viral gastroenteritis	*Rotavirus*	Vomiting, diarrhea for 1 week
Fungal Diseases		
Ergot poisoning	*Claviceps purpurea*	Restricted blood flow to limbs; hallucinogenic
Aflatoxin poisoning	*Aspergillus flavus*	Liver cirrhosis; liver cancer

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